

18 A student put a layer of plant epidermal cells on a microscope slide. The student put a drop of potassium nitrate solution on the layer of cells and observed that:

- the cell surface membrane of many of the cells had separated from the cell wall
- the cytoplasm and cell contents had shrunk.

What explains these observations?

	direction of net water movement	water potential of cells at start / kPa	water potential of solution at start / kPa
A	cells to solution	–100	–500
B	cells to solution	–500	–100
C	solution to cells	–100	–500
D	solution to cells	–500	–100